

Carbon Monoxide Exposure - Male (Child)

Algorithm 1023 | Child (0-17 years) | Gender at birth: Male

Definition

- Suspected carbon monoxide exposure assessment decomposed from NHS.UK's published emergency guidance.
- Child patient.
- Male.

Initial assessment

1. [OPEN_TEXT] Is everyone outside in fresh air now? Record exact age and sex of every exposed person, pregnancy, child/vulnerable-person status, symptoms, exposure duration/source, and whether others or pets are affected.
2. [OPEN_TEXT] What appliance or source is suspected (boiler, heater, generator, fire)?
3. [DURATION] How long has the caller been exposed?
4. [CAREGIVER_OBSERVATION] What has a safe parent or caregiver observed about alertness, breathing, pain, swelling, fever, eating or drinking, sleep, play, and normal activity?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Disposition level 100

Was there fire or smoke exposure with breathing difficulty, airway or facial burns, soot around the mouth or nose, hoarseness, severe coughing, confusion, weakness, chest or muscle pain, collapse, or loss of consciousness?

NHS.UK carbon monoxide poisoning guidance lists these as emergency ambulance or Emergency Department criteria for suspected exposure. Do not drive to hospital - call for an ambulance instead.

1. Disposition level 70

Does the caller suspect carbon monoxide, fire, or smoke exposure but have none of the emergency features above?

NHS.UK guidance recommends seeking urgent clinical review for suspected carbon monoxide exposure when severe symptoms are not present.

Advice

Qatar emergency carbon-monoxide response

- If safe, move everyone and pets into fresh air without re-entering or delaying to find the source. Call Qatar emergency services on 999 from outside and do not drive because deterioration or collapse can be sudden. Do not use flames, switches, or appliances at the suspected site. Tell 999 about all exposed people, including asymptomatic children, pregnant people, older adults, and anyone with heart/lung disease. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: headache, dizziness, vomiting, chest pain, weakness, confusion, or breathlessness; pregnancy or child exposure; loss of consciousness or seizure.

Urgent carbon monoxide or smoke-exposure review

- Leave the exposure area, go into fresh air, and do not re-enter a building or restart an appliance until emergency or safety authorities say it is safe. Use the Qatar governance-approved in-person assessment route without delay (local approval required). Escalate to Qatar 999 for breathing difficulty, hoarseness, soot, airway/facial burns, severe coughing, confusion, weakness, chest pain, collapse, or worsening symptoms.
- Call Back If: breathing difficulty, hoarseness, soot, airway or facial burns, or severe coughing; confusion, weakness, chest pain, collapse, or worsening symptoms.

First aid

- If safe, move everyone and pets into fresh air without re-entering or delaying to find the source. Call Qatar emergency services on 999 from outside and do not drive because deterioration or collapse can be sudden. Do not use flames, switches, or appliances at the suspected site. Tell 999 about all exposed people, including asymptomatic children, pregnant people, older adults, and anyone with heart/lung disease. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "Carbon monoxide poisoning", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/carbon-monoxide-poisoning/> (page last reviewed 16 December 2025)

Provenance

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